

Florida Civic Literacy Exam

A complete, plain-language study packet built around the four competencies the FCLE actually tests.

80 questions

60% to pass (48/80)

No time limit

Free at PSC

By appointment only

Retake every 7 days · unlimited

CHOOSE WHERE TO STUDY

Four competencies, one corpus

The exam draws evenly from four areas — about 25% each. Pick one to focus on, or read straight through. They overlap on purpose, so studying one reinforces the others.

1 Principles of democracy

~25%

The big ideas: social contract, rule of law, federalism, popular sovereignty, republic vs. democracy, and elections.

[Study this →](#)

2 The U.S. Constitution

~25%

The seven Articles, the key amendments, selective incorporation, and the famous clauses the Court keeps citing.

[Study this →](#)

3 Founding documents

~25%

From the Magna Carta to the Bill of Rights — what each document did and how the ideas flow into one another.

[Study this →](#)

4 Cases, laws & actions

~25%

The 26 landmark Supreme Court cases plus key legislation and executive actions. Searchable and filterable below.

[Study this →](#)

How they connect: a single question often spans two areas — a landmark case (Competency 4) usually turns on a clause or amendment (Competency 2), which traces back to a founding document (Competency 3) and the principle behind it (Competency 1). When you study a case, ask which amendment and which principle it rests on.

START HERE

What the FCLE is — and how to pass it

The Florida Civic Literacy Exam is part of Florida's civic literacy graduation requirement (State Board Rule 6A-10.02413). At Pensacola State College the exam is free, computer-based, and taken by appointment through RegisterBlast. You need 48 of 80 questions right (60%). There's no time limit, you can retake it every 7 days, and there's no cap on attempts.

●The test is split four ways — evenly

Every question fits one of four "competencies," and each one is about **25%** of the exam (roughly 20 questions each). They overlap a lot — a question about a Supreme Court case is also a question about the Constitution — so studying one helps the others. This packet gives each competency its own section: a plain-language review, key terms, a quick-reference table, and a short self-quiz.

●How to use this packet

Read the review for one competency, skim the table, then do the quiz with the answers hidden. Tap "**Show answer & explanation**" only after you commit to a choice — guessing first is what makes it stick. Then go take the official FLDOE sample items (linked at the bottom) to rehearse the real question style. Print this page anytime for a paper copy; the answers print with it.

Two paths, not one. For most recent students the requirement is a qualifying course *and* a passing assessment. POS 2041 (American National Government) or AMH 2020 (U.S. History since 1877) covers the course side. The FCLE covers the assessment side — but a CLEP American Government score of 50, AP U.S. Government score of 3, or AP U.S. History score of 4 also satisfies the assessment. Confirm with a PSC advisor which applies to the specific catalog year.

1 Principles & practices of American democracy

The big ideas behind *why* American government works the way it does — and why the Founders chose a republic instead of a pure democracy.

●Social contract & consent of the governed

People agree to give up a little freedom and form a government; in return, the government protects their rights. Its power comes from the consent of the people — and if it stops protecting them, the people can change it. This idea comes mostly from philosopher **John Locke**.

THINK OF IT LIKE joining a group project: everyone agrees to some rules so the whole team is protected. If the rules stop serving the team, the team rewrites them.

●Separation of powers & checks and balances

Government power is split into three branches — legislative, executive, judicial — so no single branch gets too strong. Each branch can "check" the others (the President can veto a law; Congress can override the veto; courts can strike laws down). The idea traces to **Montesquieu**.

THINK OF IT LIKE a safe that needs three different keys. No one person can open it alone.

●Rule of law

Everyone must follow the law — including presidents, police, and the wealthy. Power is limited by rules, not by whoever is in charge. (Nixon's claim that "when the president does it, it's not illegal" is the textbook violation of this principle.)

●Popular sovereignty

The government is created by and answers to the people. The Constitution opens with "**We the People**" for exactly this reason — authority flows up from citizens, not down from a ruler.

●Natural rights

Rights you're born with that no government grants or can take away — Locke listed life, liberty, and property; Jefferson rephrased it as life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness in the Declaration of Independence.

●Federalism

Power is shared between the national government and the state governments. Some powers belong to the nation (printing money, declaring war), some to the states (running schools, issuing licenses), and some are shared (taxing, building roads).

THINK OF IT LIKE a household: some decisions belong to the whole house, some belong to each roommate's own room.

●Republicanism vs. pure democracy

The U.S. is a **constitutional republic**: citizens elect representatives to make decisions, rather than everyone voting directly on every issue. The Founders feared a pure ("direct") democracy could let a passionate majority trample the minority, so they built representation and a constitution as guardrails. Article IV even guarantees every state a "republican form of government."

●Majority rule, minority rights, & equality under law

The majority decides, but certain rights are protected no matter what the majority wants. "Equality under the law" means equal *treatment* and equal *protection* — a fair process — not a guarantee that everyone ends up with equal results.

●Due process & individual liberty

Due process means the government must follow fair legal procedures before taking your life, liberty, or property. Individual liberty covers personal freedoms — including political and religious liberty, which the Founders prized. Rights can still be limited when they harm others (free speech doesn't protect falsely yelling "fire" in a crowded theater).

●Constitutionalism

The idea that government power must operate within the limits set by a written constitution. Leaders can only do what the constitution allows — it's the rulebook that even the rule-makers have to follow.

●Elections & the practice of self-government

Free, fair, and secure elections are how popular sovereignty actually works in practice — they're the tool citizens use to consent to (and replace) their government. Know the basics of how elections run at the **state** level (states administer elections, set many of the rules, and draw districts) and the **federal** level (electing the President through the Electoral College, plus members of Congress). The integrity of elections — accurate counting, equal access, secure ballots — is treated as essential to a functioning republic.

Popular sovereignty

Government's authority comes from the people.

Consent of the governed

A government is only legitimate if the people agree to it.

Republic

A system where people elect representatives to govern for them.

Federalism

Power divided between national and state governments.

Rule of law

No one is above the law, including leaders.

Natural rights

Rights everyone is born with — life, liberty, property/happiness.

Constitutionalism

Government power is limited by a written constitution.

Free & fair elections

Secure, equal-access voting — how citizens consent to and change their government.

QUICK SELF-CHECK • COMPETENCY 1

1. The phrase "We the People" in the Constitution's Preamble best illustrates which principle?

- A. Separation of powers
- B. Popular sovereignty
- C. Federalism
- D. Judicial review

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

"We the People" signals that the government's authority flows up from citizens — that's popular sovereignty.

2. Which philosopher's idea of the social contract and consent of the governed most influenced the Declaration of Independence?

- A. Thomas Hobbes
- B. Montesquieu
- C. John Locke
- D. Karl Marx

Show answer & explanation

Answer: C

Locke's natural rights and consent-of-the-governed ideas run straight through the Declaration. (Montesquieu is the one tied to separation of powers.)

3. The main reason the Founders chose a republic over a pure democracy was to —

- A. make voting faster
- B. protect minority rights from a runaway majority
- C. give states more power than the nation
- D. eliminate elections

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

They worried a direct majority could trample minorities, so representation plus a constitution acts as a guardrail.

4. A president claims a law does not apply to them because of their office. This most directly violates —

- A. federalism
- B. the rule of law
- C. due process
- D. popular sovereignty

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Rule of law means everyone — including the president — is bound by the law.

5. "Equality under the law" guarantees —

- A. everyone receives the same income
- B. equal treatment and protection, not equal outcomes
- C. that all laws are identical in every state
- D. that the majority always wins

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

It promises a fair, equal process — not that everyone ends up in the same place.

6. Deciding that public schools are run by states while the national government coins money is an example of —

- A. checks and balances
- B. judicial review
- C. federalism
- D. the social contract

Show answer & explanation

Answer: C

Splitting powers between national and state governments is federalism.

7. Read the passage, then answer.

"We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union... do ordain and establish this Constitution..."
— Preamble to the U.S. Constitution

Which principle does the opening phrase best reflect?

- A. Judicial review
- B. Popular sovereignty
- C. Separation of powers
- D. Federal supremacy

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

"We the People" shows authority coming from the citizens themselves — popular sovereignty. (This is the *stimulus-passage* style you'll see often on the real exam.)

2The U.S. Constitution & how it applies

What's in each Article, the amendments that matter most, and the famous clauses the Supreme Court keeps coming back to.

THE SEVEN ARTICLES — A QUICK MAP		
ARTICLE	WHAT IT SETS UP	MEMORY HOOK
I	The Legislative branch — Congress makes the laws	1 = Congress comes first
II	The Executive branch — the President enforces the laws	2 = the President
III	The Judicial branch — courts interpret the laws	3 = the courts judge
IV	States' relations; Full Faith & Credit; admitting new states; guarantees a republican form of government	4 = the states
V	How to amend (change) the Constitution	5 = reVise
VI	The Supremacy Clause — federal law outranks conflicting state law	6 = supreme
VII	Ratification — how the Constitution was approved	7 = sign-off

•Three kinds of power

Expressed (enumerated) powers are written out for the national government (declare war, coin money). **Implied** powers aren't listed but are "necessary and proper" to carry out the listed ones. **Reserved** powers belong to the states under the **10th Amendment** — anything not given to the nation or denied to the states.

•Amendments & the Bill of Rights

There are **27 amendments**. The first ten — the **Bill of Rights (1791)** — protect individual freedoms. You don't need all 27 memorized, but know the heavy hitters below.

AMENDMENTS WORTH KNOWING COLD

AMEND.	PROTECTS / DOES
1st	Speech, religion, press, assembly, petition
2nd	Right to keep and bear arms
4th	No unreasonable searches/seizures — usually needs a warrant
5th	Due process, no self-incrimination, no double jeopardy
6th	Right to a lawyer, a speedy and public trial, an impartial jury
10th	Powers not given to the nation are reserved to the states/people
13th	Abolished slavery
14th	Citizenship, due process , and equal protection applied to the states
15th	Right to vote regardless of race
19th	Right to vote regardless of sex (women's suffrage)
26th	Lowered the voting age to 18

•Selective incorporation

Originally the Bill of Rights only limited the *national* government. Over time the Supreme Court used the **14th Amendment** to apply most of those protections to the *states* too, one right at a time. That process is called selective incorporation.

•Federalists vs. Anti-Federalists

Federalists (Hamilton, Madison, Jay) supported ratifying the Constitution and a strong national government — they made their case in the **Federalist Papers**. **Anti-Federalists** feared too much central power and demanded a **Bill of Rights** as the price of their support — which is why we got one. Their best-known essay is **Brutus No. 1**, which argued the country was too large for a single strong national government.

FAMOUS CLAUSES THE COURT KEEPS CITING

CLAUSE	WHAT IT MEANS
Supremacy	Federal law wins when it conflicts with state law (Article VI)
Necessary & Proper (Elastic)	Lets Congress pass laws needed to carry out its powers — the source of implied powers
Commerce	Congress can regulate trade between states
Emoluments	Bars federal officials from accepting payments, gifts, or titles from foreign governments without consent of Congress
Full Faith & Credit	States must honor each other's laws, records, and court rulings
Due Process	Government must use fair procedures (5th & 14th Amendments)
Equal Protection	States can't deny anyone equal treatment under the law (14th Amendment)
Establishment & Free Exercise	Government can't set up an official religion or block people from practicing theirs (1st Amendment)

QUICK SELF-CHECK • COMPETENCY 2

1. Which article of the Constitution grants the powers to coin money, make treaties, and tax imports?

- A. Article I (Legislative)
- B. Article II (Executive)
- C. Article III (Judicial)
- D. Article IV (States)

Show answer & explanation

Answer: A

Those are powers of Congress, which Article I creates.

2. When a state law conflicts with a valid federal law, the conflict is resolved using the —

- A. Tenth Amendment
- B. Commerce Clause
- C. Supremacy Clause
- D. Equal Protection Clause

Show answer & explanation

Answer: C

The Supremacy Clause (Article VI) makes federal law the "supreme law of the land."

3. Powers not given to the national government and not denied to the states are —

- A. implied powers
- B. reserved to the states by the 10th Amendment
- C. expressed powers
- D. banned entirely

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

The 10th Amendment reserves leftover powers to the states and the people.

4. Police search a hotel room without a warrant or valid exception. Which amendment protects against this?

- A. Second
- B. Third
- C. Fourth
- D. Fifth

Show answer & explanation

Answer: C

The 4th Amendment guards against unreasonable searches and seizures.

5. The Anti-Federalists' biggest demand before they would support the Constitution was —

- A. a national bank
- B. a Bill of Rights
- C. a stronger president
- D. an end to elections

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Their insistence on protecting individual rights is why the Bill of Rights exists.

6. The process of applying Bill of Rights protections to state governments through the 14th Amendment is called —

- A. judicial review
- B. selective incorporation
- C. ratification
- D. nullification

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Selective incorporation extends federal rights to the states, one at a time.

3The founding documents

The texts that shaped American self-government — what each one did, and how earlier ideas fed into later ones.

DOCUMENTS & WHY THEY MATTER		
DOCUMENT	YEAR	WHY IT MATTERS
Magna Carta	1215	Limited the king's power and planted the seeds of rule of law and due process
Mayflower Compact	1620	Early example of colonists agreeing to govern themselves by consent
English Bill of Rights	1689	Limited the monarchy and protected certain rights — a model for ours
Common Sense (Paine)	1776	Persuaded ordinary colonists to support independence
Virginia Declaration of Rights	1776	Influenced both the Declaration of Independence and the Bill of Rights
Declaration of Independence	1776	Declared independence; stated natural rights and consent of the governed (Jefferson, drawing on Locke)
Massachusetts Constitution	1780	Oldest functioning written constitution in the world; its structure influenced the U.S. Constitution
Articles of Confederation	1781	First U.S. government — too weak (couldn't tax or regulate trade), so it was replaced
Northwest Ordinance	1787	Set rules for turning territories into states and banned slavery in that territory
Federalist Papers	1787-88	Essays by Hamilton, Madison & Jay arguing for ratification
U.S. Constitution	1787	The framework of the federal government still in use today
Bill of Rights	1791	First ten amendments — protects individual freedoms

•The Federalist Papers worth knowing by number

The official blueprint names five specifically:

No. 10 (Madison): a large republic is the best defense against "factions" — groups that put their own interest over the common good.

No. 14 (Madison): a large republic *can* work because it's representative, not a direct democracy where everyone must gather in one place.

No. 31 (Hamilton): the national government needs the power to tax in order to function.

No. 39 (Madison): explains that the new government is both *republican* (representative) and a blend of national and federal features.

No. 51 (Madison): checks and balances — "ambition must be made to counteract ambition" so power restrains power.

•The Articles → the Constitution story

The Articles of Confederation made the central government so weak it couldn't tax, regulate trade, or keep order. When that failed, the framers wrote the Constitution to create a stronger — but still limited — national government. Knowing this "weak-then-fixed" arc explains a lot of exam questions.

•How the ideas flow

Enlightenment thinkers (especially Locke) → the Declaration of Independence → the Constitution → the Bill of Rights. Earlier English documents (Magna Carta, English Bill of Rights) and colonial ones (Mayflower Compact, Virginia Declaration of Rights) fed into all of it. The Seneca Falls "Declaration of Sentiments" (1848) later borrowed the Declaration of Independence's structure to argue for women's rights.

QUICK SELF-CHECK • COMPETENCY 3

1. Which document is the first U.S. national government — later replaced because it was too weak?

- A. The Constitution
- B. The Articles of Confederation
- C. The Bill of Rights
- D. The Mayflower Compact

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

The Articles couldn't tax or regulate trade, so the Constitution replaced them.

2. The Mayflower Compact is best remembered as an early example of —

- A. a written constitution for the nation
- B. colonists agreeing to govern themselves by consent
- C. a declaration of war
- D. a trade agreement

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Settlers pledged to make and follow laws for the common good — self-government by consent.

3. Federalist No. 51 is most associated with which idea?

- A. Ending slavery
- B. Checks and balances ("ambition counteracts ambition")
- C. Free trade
- D. Lowering the voting age

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

No. 51 lays out how the branches check one another. (No. 10 is the one about factions.)

4. The Declaration of Independence's ideas about natural rights came most directly from —

- A. Karl Marx
- B. John Locke and Enlightenment thinking
- C. the Magna Carta authors
- D. the Federalist Papers

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Jefferson drew on Locke's natural-rights philosophy.

5. Thomas Paine's *Common Sense* (1776) mainly —

- A. created the three branches of government
- B. persuaded everyday colonists to support independence
- C. ended the Revolutionary War
- D. wrote the Bill of Rights

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

It was a plain-language pamphlet that turned public opinion toward independence.

6. The Magna Carta (1215) is significant because it —

- A. declared American independence
- B. limited the power of the king and advanced the rule of law
- C. created the U.S. Senate
- D. freed enslaved people

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

It established that even the king must follow the law — an early due-process root.

7. Read the excerpt, then answer.

"We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights..."
— Declaration of Independence (1776)

The ideas in this passage were most directly drawn from —

- A. Karl Marx's economic theory
- B. John Locke's ideas on natural rights
- C. the Articles of Confederation
- D. the Monroe Doctrine

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

The natural-rights language ("unalienable Rights") comes straight from Locke and Enlightenment thought.

4Landmark cases, legislation & executive actions

This is the most memorization-heavy competency. Learn each case as a one-line "what it decided." The table below is the single highest-value thing to study in this packet.

LANDMARK SUPREME COURT CASES — FILTER BY THEME OR SEARCH			
CASE	YEAR	WHAT IT DECIDED	THEME
Marbury v. Madison	1803	Established judicial review — courts can strike down laws that violate the Constitution	Federal power
McCulloch v. Maryland	1819	Upheld implied powers (national bank) and federal supremacy; states can't tax federal institutions	Federal power
Dred Scott v. Sandford	1857	Ruled enslaved people were not citizens; later undone by the 13th & 14th Amendments	Civil rights
Plessy v. Ferguson	1896	Allowed "separate but equal" racial segregation	Civil rights
Schenck v. U.S.	1919	Speech can be limited when it poses a "clear and present danger"	Speech
Korematsu v. U.S.	1944	Upheld Japanese-American internment — national security over civil liberties	Civil rights
Brown v. Board of Education	1954	Overtured Plessy; segregated public schools are unconstitutional	Civil rights
Mapp v. Ohio	1961	Illegally obtained evidence can't be used in court (exclusionary rule)	Criminal procedure
Baker v. Carr	1962	Opened the door to "one person, one vote" redistricting cases	Voting
Engel v. Vitale	1962	Official prayer in public schools violates the Establishment Clause	Religion

Gideon v. Wainwright	1963	Right to a lawyer even if you can't afford one	Criminal procedure
Miranda v. Arizona	1966	Police must inform suspects of their rights ("Miranda rights")	Criminal procedure
Tinker v. Des Moines	1969	Students keep free-speech rights at school (armband protest)	Speech
New York Times v. U.S.	1971	Limited "prior restraint" — strong protection for a free press (Pentagon Papers)	Speech & press
Wisconsin v. Yoder	1972	Religious freedom can exempt families from some compulsory schooling laws	Religion
Roe v. Wade	1973	Recognized an abortion right under privacy — <i>later overturned by Dobbs in 2022</i>	Civil rights
United States v. Nixon	1974	The president is not above the law; limited executive privilege (Watergate tapes)	Federal power
Regents of UC v. Bakke	1978	Strict racial quotas are unconstitutional, but race could be one factor in admissions	Civil rights
Hazelwood v. Kuhlmeier	1988	Schools may regulate the content of school-sponsored student newspapers	Speech
Texas v. Johnson	1989	Flag burning is protected symbolic speech	Speech
Shaw v. Reno	1993	Drawing districts mainly by race can violate equal protection (racial gerrymandering)	Voting
U.S. v. Lopez	1995	Limited the Commerce Clause — Congress had overreached (guns near schools)	Federal power
Bush v. Gore	2000	Ended the Florida recount and decided the 2000 presidential election	Voting
District of Columbia v. Heller	2008	The 2nd Amendment protects an individual right to own a firearm	2nd Amendment
McDonald v. Chicago	2010	Applied the 2nd Amendment to the states (incorporation)	2nd Amendment
Citizens United v. FEC	2010	Political spending by corporations and unions is protected speech	Speech

Study note on Roe v. Wade. Florida's official FCLE materials list Roe among landmark cases, and the exam may still reference what it *decided* in 1973. Just know the update: the Supreme Court overturned Roe in *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization* (2022), returning abortion regulation to the states.

•Landmark legislation — the categories to recognize

You don't need every law, just the *type*: compromises over slavery (Compromise of 1850, Kansas-Nebraska Act 1854), expansion and government structure (Homestead Act 1862, Pendleton Act 1883 civil-service reform), civil rights expansions or restrictions (Civil Rights Act of 1964; Alien & Sedition Acts 1798; USA PATRIOT Act 2001), social

programs (New Deal acts, Great Society acts, Affordable Care Act 2010), environmental protection (Clean Air Act 1970), and war powers (Gulf of Tonkin Resolution 1964).

•Landmark executive actions

Recognize these forms: treaties ending wars or expanding territory (Louisiana Purchase 1803, Treaty of Paris 1898), suspensions of rights in crisis (Lincoln suspending habeas corpus; Japanese internment via Executive Order 9066), and executive orders that expanded rights (Truman desegregating the military, EO 9981). The Monroe Doctrine — opposing new European colonization in the Americas — is a classic foreign-policy example.

QUICK SELF-CHECK • COMPETENCY 4

1. Which case established judicial review — the power of courts to strike down unconstitutional laws?

- A. Marbury v. Madison
- B. Plessy v. Ferguson
- C. Miranda v. Arizona
- D. Bush v. Gore

Show answer & explanation

Answer: A

Marbury v. Madison (1803) gave the Court the power of judicial review.

2. A defendant who cannot afford a lawyer is denied one at trial. Which case says that's unconstitutional?

- A. Mapp v. Ohio
- B. Gideon v. Wainwright
- C. McCulloch v. Maryland
- D. Plessy v. Ferguson

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Gideon v. Wainwright (1963) guarantees the right to counsel even if you can't pay.

3. Brown v. Board of Education (1954) is significant because it —

- A. upheld "separate but equal"
- B. overturned segregation in public schools
- C. legalized flag burning
- D. established Miranda rights

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Brown overturned Plessy and ended legal segregation in public schools.

4. Which case decided that a president must comply with the law and turn over evidence, limiting executive privilege?

- A. United States v. Nixon
- B. Citizens United v. FEC
- C. Korematsu v. U.S.
- D. Baker v. Carr

Show answer & explanation

Answer: A

U.S. v. Nixon (1974) made clear the president is not above the law.

5. The Louisiana Purchase (1803) is an example of a landmark —

- A. Supreme Court case
- B. executive action (territorial expansion)
- C. constitutional amendment
- D. civil rights law

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

It was an executive action that roughly doubled the country's size.

6. Which case upheld the government's restriction of civil liberties in the name of national security during wartime?

- A. Tinker v. Des Moines
- B. Korematsu v. United States
- C. Engel v. Vitale
- D. Gideon v. Wainwright

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

Korematsu (1944) upheld Japanese-American internment — security over liberty.

7. Read the excerpt from a Supreme Court opinion, then answer.

"It is emphatically the province and duty of the judicial department to say what the law is... a law repugnant to the constitution is void."

— Chief Justice John Marshall

Which case does this opinion come from, and what power did it establish?

- A. Brown v. Board — desegregation
- B. Marbury v. Madison — judicial review
- C. Miranda v. Arizona — rights on arrest
- D. McCulloch v. Maryland — implied powers

Show answer & explanation

Answer: B

This is Marshall in *Marbury v. Madison* (1803), establishing judicial review — the Court's power to strike down unconstitutional laws.

GAME PLAN

A simple study plan & test-day checklist

•A one-week rhythm that works

Spread it out — cramming hurts on a test this broad. Try one competency a day for four days, redo the quizzes the next day with answers hidden, then take the official FLDOE sample items twice before test day. Because the four competencies overlap, your second pass will feel much easier than your first.

•Highest-value moves

Memorize the **landmark-cases table** (Competency 4) first — it's the most "fact recall" and the easiest points. Then lock in the **seven Articles** and the **key amendments**. The principles in Competency 1 are mostly common-sense reasoning once you know the vocabulary, so they're efficient to review last.

•Remember the exam's design

No time limit means there's no reason to rush — read every scenario twice. And you can retake every 7 days with no cap on attempts, so a first attempt that doesn't pass is just a practice run that tells you exactly what to review.

Test-day checklist (PSC)

- ☐ **Book the appointment.** The FCLE is by appointment only through RegisterBlast — it can't be taken as a walk-in.
- ☐ **Bring a valid photo ID.** Testing centers require government or school photo identification.
- ☐ **Know it's free.** There's no charge for the FCLE at Pensacola State College.
- ☐ **No time pressure.** The platform sets no time limit — pace yourself and re-read scenarios.
- ☐ **Aim for 48.** Passing is 60% — 48 of 80 correct.
- ☐ **Plan your retake if needed.** You can test again after 7 days, as many times as it takes.
- ☐ **Need accommodations?** The testing platform supports disability accommodations — arrange them with PSC

GO TO THE SOURCE

Official resources & links

These are the authoritative materials. Practice the real question style with the FLDOE sample items, and use the PSC library guide for competency-by-competency review.

PRACTICE

FLDOE — FCLE Sample Items (official)

40 retired-style questions with an answer key, written by the state. The closest thing to a real practice test. Use this directly from the source.

<https://www.fldoe.org/core/fileparse.php/5663/urlt/FCLESampleItem.pdf>

SCOPE

FLDOE — Supplemental Guide for the FCLE

The official breakdown of what each competency covers — the blueprint this packet's review is built around.

<https://www.fldoe.org/core/fileparse.php/5663/urlt/SuppGuideFCLE.pdf>

REVIEW

PSC Library — Civic Literacy Research Guide

Dedicated pages for each of the four competencies, plus an FCLE Review PowerPoint, review videos, and Kahoot study sets.

<https://researchguides.pensacolastate.edu/civilliteracy>

LOGISTICS

PSC Testing — FCLE Page (scheduling & rules)

Official PSC details: fees, appointments, passing score, retake policy, and the RegisterBlast scheduling links.

<https://testing.pensacolastate.edu/tests/florida-civic-literacy-exam-fcle/>

ALT PATH

Modern States — free CLEP American Government course

FLDOE-recommended free online course. Covers the same content and can satisfy the assessment via the CLEP exam if that route fits better.

<https://modernstates.org>

DEEP DIVE

Oyez — Supreme Court case summaries

Free, readable summaries (and audio) for every landmark case in Competency 4. Great for turning a one-liner into real understanding.

<https://www.oyez.org>